



Netflix announce horror anthology

Guillermo del Toro has announced that he is creating a horror anthology series for Netflix. <https://dgit.in/jun18-A61-1>



Apple's 55 autonomous cars

Apple's self-driving car fleet has risen significantly from January, with 55 autonomous cars on road. <https://dgit.in/jun18-A61-2>

Next would be to pick your switches. Hopefully, before you've gotten to this point, you've tried out all the different keys we've mentioned earlier in the article and figured out the one that suits you the best. You can buy about 10 Cherry MX RGB switches for \$4. So your total purchase comes down to \$24 just for the keys. The great thing about buying these keys in reduced quantities is that you can switch out



Carribean PBT DYE-SUB keycaps

keys based on the usage. Let's say you game a lot on your machine and there's a likelihood that the WASD keys might experience more wear and tear, then use keys that are more durable for the WASD keys.

With the switches out of the way, you now have the keycaps to think about. Since they take up most of the space on the keyboard, your overall aesthetics are strongly influenced by your choice of keycaps. Also, if you're going for backlighting, then you might want to decide on whether you want the light to permeate the keyboard or stay opaque and give you a soft underglow. Depending on your choice of material for the key caps, they can either cost you as low as \$40 for the entire set to over \$150. Just ensure that the profile of the keycaps match whatever switched you've picked. Cherry MX keycaps go best with Cherry MX switches and so on. You can even get blank keycaps and put the lettering on them later. Your choices are unlimited.

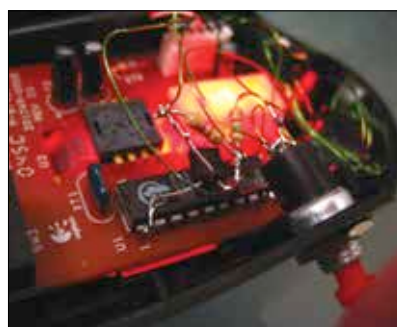
The last thing on your list is the cable which depends on the interface your PCB has. Generally, it's a USB Type-C to Type-A cable with choice of

material being rubber, plastic and with all the fancy coatings and sheaths. That's about it, put everything together and you've built the most custom keyboard that can be.

MICE

Like keyboards, mice are also quite personal. However, they don't offer the same level of customisability as keyboards. It's not as simple as buying the right components and putting them together like we experienced with keyboards. With mice, you need to bring your DIY skills to the table. Before we get to modding, let's see what all parameters affect your experience.

First, there are the switches which affect how you click. It can be soft or it can be stubborn, and there's also the sound that the key makes. Then there are the slip pads underneath the mouse which decides how well it glides on the mouse pad. You can't mod the sensor without changing the algorithm, so modding the sensor is a bit difficult. The illuminating diode i.e. the LED can be changed from a laser diode to a normal LED mechanically, but they interact differently with the sensor. Laser diodes are generally run on PWM to prevent them from heating up while LEDs run on constant and can also run on PWN. Switching out a constant LED for a laser diode will burn the laser out. So unless you account for such intricacies, it's best to leave the main circuitry untouched. Most mice have a pretty standard circuit, so there generally are provisions to add additional switches for increased functionality. The last functional mod would be to alter the weight



Trigger switch mod

of the mouse to suit your use case.

If you're good with soldering, then you can easily get some of these mods out of the way quickly. Swapping your existing cable for a better braided cable comes down to desoldering the existing USB cable and soldering the new one in. Then there are the switches which tend to develop clicking issues within a few years if not months. To sort that out, you can buy switches that are commonly used by most manufacturers such as the Omron submarine switches and solder them in. The contact pads are pretty much standardised in the industry. Like keyboard switches, you have a lot of options within the world of mice too, however, the variance between functionalities is very limited.

Changing weight is actually simpler than you might think. Most mice come with an aluminium plate within the upper chassis that weighs the mouse down. When you open the



Change how your mouse glides over the pad

mouse chassis, you can simply add to the weight by supergluing a few coins onto the plate or you can file the metal plate to reduce weight.

The last mod would be to switch out the feet. With popular mice, you can find feet made of different materials cut out in the proper shapes. If you're unlucky to not get pre-cut feet for your mouse then you can always buy sheets and cut them out yourself. PTFE is one of the most common materials used for mouse feet and they offer a nice balance between smoothness and drag over rubberised mats. A single sheet of 1mm thickness can cost about ₹250 and you can make 20-30 sets of feet with one 30 x 30 cm sheet.